

However, we always aim to provide enough resources to students in India. We are already supporting children through our partnership with the Kerala government. Rather than participating entirely in a government-led programme, we are providing resources in the form of hardware and software documentation to help young developers. That is a good model as India is a massive place.

Q Universities such as Cambridge and Harvard are providing Raspberry Pi to their students. Are you in talks with some Indian institutes to give the same power of open source computing to local budding developers in India?

We have the initiative in Kerala to provide computing through Raspberry Pi to the local school students. The good thing about Raspberry Pi is that it works as a standard platform and uses a Linux-based operating system to help a large number of budding developers. Generally, even in the University of Cambridge or at Harvard, we don't interact directly with the alumni.

We actually made the decision to build the hardware cheap. Our strategy to support young developers is through a simple, cheap and standardised platform. The universities and institutions can deploy the hardware themselves and enhance the knowledge of their students in an effective and efficient manner.

Q Where does India rank globally on the list of potential markets for Raspberry Pi and the Raspberry Pi Foundation?

We have two distributors supplying Raspberry Pi units in India, and both supply roughly 2 to 3 per cent of our global shipments, to the Indian market. Also, India is the biggest APAC country after China in terms of the sales of Raspberry Pi.

Globally, India stands at No. 6 and sits behind some developed markets like the US, UK, Germany and China. We certainly want to do better to improve the existing presence of Raspberry Pi in the Indian market. India is kind of a dream market for the Raspberry Pi Foundation and it should become a US-sized market in the near future.

Q Where do you see Raspberry Pi in the future, in relation to the IoT and open source?

Raspberry Pi is a good platform for prototyping IoT applications. But what is more interesting for me is when the people continue to stay on Raspberry Pi even after building a prototype, using the same platform to even finish their final product.

We are now allowing customers to buy customised Raspberry Pi units. This enables a large number of our customers to tweak the prime features of Raspberry Pi and even change the shape of the device to match their requirements.

Regarding open source, we are already an open source software platform. The millions of man hours and engineering that was involved in the development of Linux indeed helped us design Raspberry Pi. Thus, we try to give back to the open source community.

We are providing the community with the platform that lets a large number of developers build new open source software. Also, we are spending heavily in improving the kernels and software that are already available to the open source world.

Q What is the prime reason a developer would prefer a Raspberry Pi?

Just one thing; it is the size of the community. We have sold over nine million units of Raspberry Pi so far.

We have a large and friendly community that enables easy resolving of issues on your Raspberry Pi. We provide official forums on our website that are consistently

moderated by our team to offer the best solutions to the users.

One of the interesting things about the Raspberry Pi is that it enables embedded engineering while being a cheap, low-power Linux platform. It builds enterprise skill sets and allows people to apply their embedded skills.

By bringing out a more enterprise-oriented feature set into the embedded space, we are going to change the engineering of this newly emerged space.

Q So apart from just the hardware, the Raspberry Pi Foundation maintains a strong community. What are your thoughts on the need for a community to develop a unique computing experience?

A community is not just needed to develop a unique computing experience but also to create a unique culture involving a great mixture of people. A lot of organisations have gained success through strong community support.

Some people wanted to get involved in embedded computing but could not due to the lack of resources and skills. In our case, the community power helped such people and let them start developing new products by interacting with others on the same platform.

Modern computing systems are complicated, and the computing experience is hard. When I was a kid, we worked with just 32K of RAM to learn everything about computers. However, you now need to stand on the shoulders of other people and need experts to learn new things about the computing world. The need for a strong community does arise. So it is wonderful to have dedicated community support.

Q When can we expect an official Android version for Raspberry Pi users?

We are not going to do this for ourselves. Android is certainly

“India is kind of a dream market for the Raspberry Pi Foundation and it should become a US-sized market in the near future.”